

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The Beginning of a Big Computers Empire!



Learning Outcome:

Identify information about the history of software and its characteristics in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- What's IBM?
- How do you think Microsoft was during the 80s?

Can Do Statements:

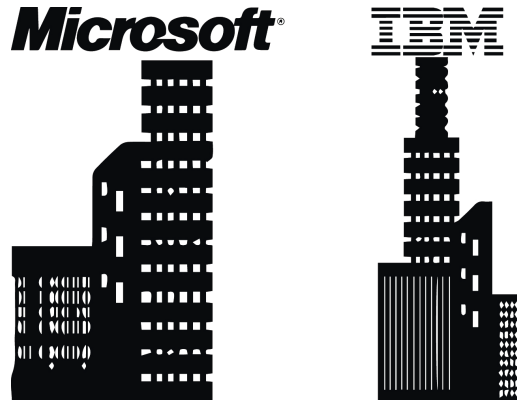
- I can read about the appearance of the IBM company in the PC business in relation to the Microsoft company.
- I can use vocabulary related to the importance of IBM and Microsoft in the PC business.
- I can write a summary of a text about the history of PCs and software.





Let's Explore!

The following is the story of how IBM influenced the success of Microsoft:



Instructions: Read the text below.

The IBM PC and the Rise of Microsoft

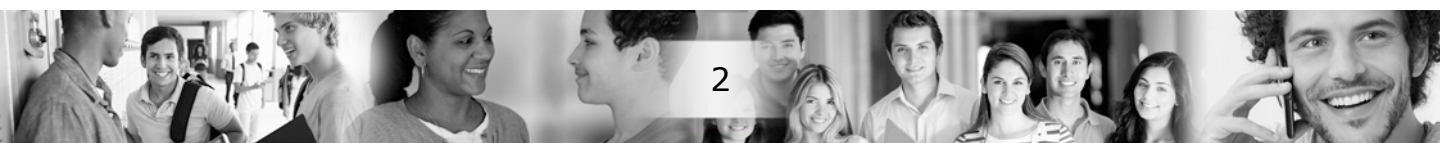
After the Apple II and other initial microcomputers were successful back in the late 70s, IBM®, the American multinational technology company, started to consider joining the market. By July 1980 Bill Lowe, chief of level systems division, made a presentation to IBM senior management on why the company had to make a move. Using standard components was Lowe's main argument to start with the new microcomputer's production. Management got an agree and the project received the green light. The device was ready in less than a year.

Its microprocessor was an Intel 8088. Both the operating system and a version of the BASIC programming language were supplied by Microsoft®; Tando provided the Disk drives; the printers came from Epson, and the Word processor and spreadsheet were among its applications software.

Was it successful? Yes, it was a commercial success. There was no microcomputer like it and by August 12th, 1981 IBM was forced to quadruple its production. Since the standard components for this microcomputer were provided by other outsourcing manufacturers, anybody was able to copy the design. IBM then decided to license the PC's operating system and looked for Microsoft's aid to do so.

How did they do it? Although Microsoft didn't have an operating system, Steve Jobs quickly bought one called QDOS from another small company. It was renamed MS-DOS and licensed to IBM. However, a contending company developed a rival operating system called DR-DOS. IBM's operating system was then renamed PC-DOS. Both the core of the battle and the economic success were in the development of operating systems.

In spite of making an alliance with IBM to develop DOS successor's called OS/2, Microsoft quit the project and focused on the development of something called Windows NT. In 1992 Windows 3.11 was released and was the first to successfully use a graphical user interface.



**Let's Practice!**

IBM® and Microsoft play an important role.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to complete each sentence. You can use the words more than once.

were / Both / was

1. IBM® started to consider joining the market after the Apple II and other initial microcomputers _____ accepted.
2. 1980 _____ a crucial year for IBM®. Bill Lowe made a presentation to IBM®'s senior management.
3. Lowe's main argument _____ to start with the new microcomputer's production.
4. Its microprocessor was an Intel 8088. _____ the operating system and a version of the BASIC programming language were supplied by Microsoft®.

**Let's Practice!**

How important IBM and Microsoft were for the PC business?

Instructions: Select the correct options to correctly complete each sentences.

1. The microprocessor Intel 8088 (wasn't / were / was) a complete success!
2. Since there (wasn't / was / were) no microcomputer like it, IBM was forced to quadruple its production.
3. The components for this microcomputer (is / was / were) provided by other manufacturers, anybody was able to copy the design.
4. Steve Jobs quickly bought an operating system called QDOS from another small company. It (was / were / weren't) renamed MS-DOS and licensed to IBM.



Extension Activity

Let's investigate more about Microsoft and IBM!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for more information about the history of Microsoft and IBM.
- Make a timeline in which you show the most relevant facts and dates of these two companies.
- Share your timeline with the rest of your class.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I look for information about IBM and Microsoft. ☐ ☐
- I make a timeline to show the most important events of IBM and Microsoft. ☐ ☐
- I share my timeline with my class. ☐ ☐



Target Words

- **disk drive** (noun): the device for reading and writing data on a computer disk.
e.g. Tando provided the Disk drives; the printers came from Epson, and the Word processor and spreadsheet were among its applications software.
- **the green light** (idiom): to get authorization for something to happen
e.g. Management agreed and the project was given the green light.
- **microcomputer** (noun): personal computer
e.g. Using standard components was Lowe's main argument to start with the new microcomputer's production.
- **operating system** (noun): software that controls the overall functioning of a computer
e.g. Both the operating system and a version of the BASIC programming language were supplied by Microsoft.
- **programming language** (noun): a language which makes the computer work
e.g. Both the operating system and a version of the BASIC programming language were supplied by Microsoft.



Learning Points

Simple past tense of be (Review of all forms)

The verb to be is used in different ways. When it is used in its past simple form it only has two forms, **was** and **were**.

The verb to be has different uses.

It helps us identify what the **role** of the subject was: Apple II **was** a successful microcomputer.

It is used to describe **how** something was (used with an adjective):
The first computers **were** big and slow.

It is also used to talk about the location of something: IBM already **was** in New York during the 1960's.

In the following charts, you can see the different forms of the verb **to be** in the past:

Affirmative		
Subject	To be verb past form	Complement
<i>Users</i>	<i>Were</i>	<i>still skeptical about the new microcomputers.</i>

Negative		
Subject	To be verb past form (negative)	Complement
<i>The computer design</i>	<i>wasn't</i>	<i>ready until a decade later.</i>

Interrogative			
Wh question	To be verb past form	Subject	Complement + ?
<i>Why</i>	<i>Was</i>	<i>IBM</i>	<i>successful?</i>
	<i>were</i>	<i>these microcomputers</i>	<i>useful?</i>





Learning Points

Examples

- *Using standard components was Lowe's main argument to start with the new microcomputer's production.*
- *The device was ready in less than a year.*
- *Was it successful? Yes, it was a commercial success.*
- *How did they do it?*
- *In 1992 Windows 3.11 was released and was the first to successfully use a graphical user interface.*

How to Summarize a Text?

When you need to summarize a text it is important that you understand it very well, so you can write only the most relevant facts and conclusions.

These are useful tips that help you to create a summarizing text.

1. As we mention previously, you should read thoroughly the text, make sure you understand the main ideas and the general meaning.
2. Be careful with hidden information, sometimes you have to "read between lines".
3. Highlight the main points of the text, important ideas you might want to include in the summarizing text. You can also use diagrams or pictures to help the understanding process.

Be careful!

Don't get confused. Remember that a summarizing is a short and easy text to read which contains the most relevant information. You should write the text in your own words, and do not use fragments from the original.

Remember that successful reading is easier when the text shows correct grammar, punctuation and coherence.

